MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 2

"Say When"

Episode 2x02. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x02. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Monday, October 3, 2005, 5:12 AM through 11:52 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 40 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x01

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Monday, October 3, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Monday, October 3, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	25
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	25
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (21.5 weeks pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Dr. Isaiah Crump	Chief of Pediatric Surgery	Mar 11, 1944	61
Franklin Bassett, Esq.	General Counsel	Oct 28, 1958	46
Bernadette 'Bernie' Watkins	Executive Assistant to the Chief	Jun 6, 1950	55
Dr. Horace Whitlow (on-screen debut)	Chief of Medicine	Sep 19, 1949	56
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	Fetal Surgeon; Esther's husband	Mar 3, 1971	34
Curtis Lemieux	Patient: post-transplant rejection	Apr 9, 1961	44
Lt. Tanisha 'Tee' Rollins	FDNY EMS Lieutenant	Aug 16, 1976	29
Tyrell 'Bird' Pickens (new)	Patient: GSW, liver	Jun 7, 1989	16
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Booker Haines (new)	Patient: trigeminal neuralgia	May 16, 1941	64
Mae Haines (new)	Booker's wife	Feb 8, 1943	62
Lula Pickens (new)	Tyrell's grandmother; MTA station agent	Feb 11, 1941	64
Kordell Pickens (new)	Tyrell's brother	Mar 2, 1994	11
Nadia Ellerbe (new)	Patient: fetal SCT, mirror syndrome	Apr 25, 1977	28
Malik Ellerbe (new)	Nadia's husband; Con Ed lineman	Jan 30, 1975	30
Odile Lemieux	Curtis's mother	Mar 19, 1936	69
Mrs. Evangeline Truitt	QGH board member	Dec 1, 1934	70
Det. Lawrence Fyffe (new)	NYPD 113th Precinct	Nov 21, 1966	38
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	45
Dr. Paulette Greenidge (new)	Couples therapist, Brooklyn Heights	Aug 1, 1955	50
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	42

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Daniella (new)	Fordham Law student at Monty's	Jul 9, 1978	27
Russell Jeffries	Elxa's husband	Apr 3, 1975	30

Also appearing: FDNY paramedic Andre Fontaine, a circulating nurse, an L&D; nurse, a fetal cardiologist, two anesthesiologists, the NICU team, a scrub nurse and Monty's patrons. Mentioned: Barry Marshall and Robin Warren (Nobel laureates), Rev. Ashworth, Judge Kittredge, Aunt Bernadine (Rocky Mount, NC), Ahmad Cummings, Malcolm Sloan and Lionel Lemieux.

COLD OPEN

1 EXT. GANTRY PLAZA STATE PARK - RIVERFRONT PROMENADE - DAWN

MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 5:12 AM

First light over the East River. The Pepsi-Cola sign still glows red against a sky turning gray-blue. A lone runner comes down the promenade: MARC (26), in a gray Howard Bison hoodie, headphones in, running hard. He's been doing this every morning for three weeks.

He stops at the end of the pier, hands on his knees, breathing steam into the October air. Across the water, Manhattan wakes up one window at a time.

MARC (V.O.)
There's a word every surgeon learns in the first week of internship. It's the most important word in the operating room.

He takes out his phone. Scrolls. A thread from ESTHER. The last message is three weeks old: "i told him 30 days of talking. i wanted you to hear it from me first this time." Below it, nothing from him.

He scrolls up. Further up. August. A photo she sent from the boat: Christmas lights on the boom. He looks at it a long time.

MARC (V.O.)
You say it to the scrub nurse when the suction's full. To the anesthesiologist when the pressure's high enough. To the resident who's retracting so hard the tissue tears.

He closes the phone. Puts it away. Starts running back.

MARC (V.O.)
"Enough."

2 INT. THE CLARENCE - CABIN - DAWN
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 5:20 AM

Flushing Bay. ESTHER (26) sits at the galley table in a robe, a calendar in front of her: September, crossed off day by day in red pen. Twenty-one red X's. She draws the twenty-second on October 3.

Taped to the cabin wall, a business card: "DR. PAULETTE GREENIDGE, LCSW-R. COUPLES AND FAMILY THERAPY. MONTAGUE STREET, BROOKLYN HEIGHTS." Handwritten on the back: "Mon/Thu 6:30 PM. Session 7."

Her phone, beside the calendar, shows a text: "See you at 6:30. Thank you for still coming. -C"

She reads it. Puts the phone face down. Picks up the red pen and looks at the eight days that are left.

MARC (V.O.)
Nobody tells you the hardest part. (beat) Knowing when.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - MORNING
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 5:41 AM

Marc comes in sweaty from the run. HARMONY (26) is at the stove making grits. RAVEN (25) sits at the island in a bonnet, reading the Daily News. The little kitchen TV is on NY1.

RAVEN
(not looking up)
You ran again.

MARC
I ran again.

RAVEN
Three weeks. Every morning. (beat) Healthy people don't run that much, Bullock. Healthy people sleep.

MARC
(grabbing water)
Dr. Wise said find somewhere to put it.

HARMONY
(stirring)
She meant a hobby. Like pottery.

MARC
I'm not doing pottery, Double-O.

HARMONY
(beat)
You'd be good at pottery. You have very gentle hands.

Raven looks up from the paper at Harmony. Harmony stirs the grits very intently.

On NY1, the anchor: "...and in Stockholm this morning, the Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine was awarded to two Australian doctors, Barry Marshall and Robin Warren, for discovering that most stomach ulcers are caused by a bacterium, Helicobacter pylori. Marshall famously proved it by drinking the bacteria himself..."

RAVEN
(horrified)
He drank it?

MARC
(grinning)
Gave himself gastritis on purpose. In 1984. Nobody believed him, so he made himself the experiment.

RAVEN
That's the most doctor thing I've ever heard.

HARMONY
(dishing grits)
That's the most MAN thing I've ever heard. (beat) "Nobody believed me, so I hurt myself to prove it." (handing Marc a bowl) Eat.

Marc looks at her. Something in how she said it. He eats.

4 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - THE BOARD - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 6:00 AM

The interns gather at the Board. Esther arrives last and stands at the far end. Three weeks of this: a careful, polite six feet of distance. AMOND (26), pale, a hand casually on his right side, reads the Nobel story in the Times. ARIANNA (25) chews a bagel.

ELXA (28), twenty-one and a half weeks pregnant and very, very done with it, waddles in with her charts.

ELXA
Morning. Don't speak to me. My feet are the size of Rhode Island. (beat) Assignments. (beat) Bullock: fetal surgery with Dr. Hartwell and Dr. Crump. Twenty-six-week fetus with a sacrococcygeal teratoma. Open fetal surgery. Possibly today.

A ripple goes through the room. Esther looks at the floor. Marc doesn't react.

MARC
(evenly)
Yes, Dr. Bullock.

ELXA
(beat, lower)
Crump asked for you by name. And Hartwell agreed. (beat) I protested. The Chief overruled me. (beat) You want out, you tell me now.

MARC
(beat)
A baby with a tumor bigger than his own heart? (beat) I don't want out.

ELXA
(nodding)
Fine. (to the room) Smilley: Graves. Microvascular decompression for trigeminal neuralgia, first case. Divine, Ellison, Cummings: my trauma service. It's going to be a busy one. Somebody's always shooting somebody on a Monday. (beat) Baker: Dr. Bullock, Senior. Lemieux's biopsy is at seven. His mother lands at LaGuardia at nine.

AMOND
(stiffly)
I'm aware.

ELXA
(beat, studying him)
You look gray, Baker.

AMOND
I read the Nobel coverage. (holding up the paper) Ulcers are an infectious disease. It's very upsetting.

Arianna snorts into her bagel. Elxa doesn't laugh. She keeps looking at him a second longer. Then she goes.

5 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EXECUTIVE CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY

MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 6:30 AM

The twelfth floor. A long table with coffee, pastries nobody eats, and the department chiefs of Queens Grace. Natasha (47) at the head. Robert (49), Graves (52), Crump (61) and Franklin Bassett (46) among them. Bernie (55) takes minutes.

At the other end of the table: DR. HORACE WHITLOW (56), Chief of Medicine. Silver hair, a three-piece suit, a Phi Beta Kappa key on his watch chain, and the smoothest voice in Queens. He smiles like a man about to win at chess.

WHITLOW
(pleasantly)
Item four. Before we go to the budget. (beat) The Bridge Fund pharmacy.

NATASHA
(evenly)
It's on page eleven, Horace. It's under "gifts received."

WHITLOW
Page eleven. A one-billion-dollar fund, with this hospital chosen for the first hospital-based pharmacy in New York. Established in twenty-four hours. (beat) By the Victor Donohue Foundation. (beat) Chaired by your father, Natasha.

Silence around the table. Bassett sets down his pen.

NATASHA
(calm)
My father's Foundation has funded children's hospitals on four continents since 1978. Queens Grace has received Foundation grants for twenty-seven years, long before I worked here. And we took forty-one Katrina evacuees in one day. (beat) Where would you prefer the insulin went, Horace?

WHITLOW
(smiling)
Oh, I'm grateful for the insulin. (beat) I'm curious about the speed. And about the gentleman who came through the loading dock on August ninth at a quarter to five in the morning. (beat) Our security log says Mr. Toles escorted a "visitor." The visitor was not logged by name.

Robert's coffee cup stops halfway to his mouth. Graves doesn't move at all. Natasha doesn't blink.

NATASHA
(pleasantly)
My father visited a dying child, Horace. He does that. He doesn't like cameras. (beat) Was there something improper about a seventy-two-year-old surgeon visiting a ten-year-old with neuroblastoma?

WHITLOW
(spreading his hands)
Nothing at all. (beat) I'd simply like the Medical Executive Committee to review all Foundation-related gifts, visits and relationships with this hospital's staff. Full disclosure. (beat) For the board. For the Joint Commission. For the appearance of propriety.

BASSETT
(carefully)
The board would have to approve a review like that.

WHITLOW
(smiling at Natasha)
Then I'll ask the board. (beat) Mrs. Truitt sits on it, doesn't she? Lovely woman.

Natasha smiles back. Two predators who have been circling each other for six years.

NATASHA
(evenly)
Item five, Bernie.

6 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - FETAL THERAPY OFFICE - DAY

MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 6:48 AM

A new office on the eleventh floor, with half-unpacked boxes and a Brigham diploma leaning against the wall. An ultrasound image glows on a light box. Clayton (34) stands in front of it in a crisp white coat. DR. ISAIAH CRUMP (61), bow tie, peers at it with his reading glasses. Marc comes in and stops.

CLAYTON
(not turning around)
Dr. Bullock. Good. (beat) Come look at this.

Marc goes to the light box. A fetal ultrasound: a tiny body and, attached to the base of its spine, a mass almost as big as the baby itself, swirled with blood vessels.

CRUMP
Type I sacrococcygeal teratoma. Mostly solid. Ten centimeters. (beat) And it's stealing his blood. Look at the flow.

MARC
(studying it)
High-output failure. The tumor's acting like a giant arteriovenous shunt. (beat) The heart's pumping for two bodies and only one of them is him.

CLAYTON
(glancing at him)
And?

MARC
(pointing)
Placentomegaly. Early hydrops. Skin edema here, and a small pericardial effusion. (beat) And the mother's swelling?

CLAYTON
(impressed despite himself)
Mirror syndrome. Starting. Her blood pressure's one-fifty over ninety-five this morning.

CRUMP
(to Clayton)
I told you he'd see it.

Clayton turns and looks at Marc directly for the first time in three weeks.

CLAYTON
(evenly)
Dr. Crump says you want pediatric surgery. (beat) Today you'll see the youngest pediatric surgery there is. (beat) Twenty-six weeks. We open the mother's uterus, bring the baby's back end out, debulk the tumor, put him back in and close her up. And then we pray she stays pregnant.

MARC
(beat)
Has it been done in New York?

CLAYTON
(beat)
Not in Queens. (beat) Philadelphia, San Francisco, a handful of cases. (beat) I spent three months at CHOP during my fellowship and scrubbed on two of them. Both babies lived.

CRUMP
(dryly)
Gentlemen. Whatever is going on between the two of you, and I've been told a great deal about it by people who should know better, it stays in this office. (beat) Down there, there is a baby.

MARC
(beat)
Yes, sir.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Agreed.

They look at each other. A professional truce. For now.

7 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC CATHETERIZATION LAB - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 7:10 AM

CURTIS LEMIEUX (44), three and a half weeks post-transplant, lies on the table, awake, a sheath in his right neck. Robert threads a bioptome through the jugular vein into the new heart under fluoroscopy. Amond stands at his elbow in a lead apron. He's sweating under it.

ROBERT
(watching the screen)
Bioptome's in the right ventricle. Septal wall. (beat) Bite.

A tiny snip. Robert withdraws a fleck of tissue and drops it into formalin.

CURTIS
(watching the screen)
That's my heart?

ROBERT
That's the heart you were given. (beat) We take a little piece of it every week, Mr. Lemieux, to make sure your immune system isn't attacking it. (beat) Four more bites.

CURTIS
(to Amond)
You look worse than me, baby doctor.

AMOND
(flat)
It's the lead apron. It weighs fifteen pounds.

CURTIS
(beat)
My mama gets in at nine. She's never flown before. (beat) She flew in a helicopter off the I-10. She says that doesn't count.

Robert takes another bite. Amond hands him the formalin jar. As he turns, he grips the edge of the table for a half-second. Only Robert's eyes move. He sees it.

ROBERT
(quietly, eyes on the screen)
Dr. Baker. After this, my office.

AMOND
(beat)
I have the path at nine and Mrs. Lemieux at...

ROBERT
(still quiet)
After this.

8 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 1 - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 7:26 AM

The doors burst open. TEE ROLLINS (29) and ANDRE FONTAINE with a stretcher. On it: TYRELL "BIRD" PICKENS (16), skinny, in a bloody white tee, gasping, a pressure dressing on his right upper abdomen.

TEE
Tyrell Pickens, sixteen. GSW, right upper quadrant, single entry, no exit. Found on a bench at the Baisley Park Houses at oh-seven-hundred. Tachy at one-thirty-two, pressure eighty-eight over fifty. Two large-bore lines, a liter in. (beat, lower) Elxa. It's his third time. I've brought him in twice before.

Elxa, Raven, Arianna and Harmony move in. Gloria (53) is already hanging blood.

ELXA
(examining)
Distended belly. FAST, please. (beat) Tyrell, can you hear me? I'm Dr. Bullock.

TYRELL
(gasping, eyes rolling)
Don't... don't call my grandma.

RAVEN
(holding his hand)
Too late, baby. She's on her way.

ARIANNA
(on the ultrasound)
Free fluid in Morison's pouch. Lots.

ELXA
Liver. OR Three, now. (to the nurse) Activate the massive transfusion protocol.

Harmony cuts the rest of his shirt. On his ribs: two old round scars. Old bullet wounds. And a third, a long surgical scar down the middle of his belly from two years ago.

HARMONY
(quietly)
Two years ago, they opened him all the way. (beat) He was fourteen.

TYRELL
(to Raven, desperate)
If I tell, they'll kill my little brother.

RAVEN
Nobody's asking you to tell anything, Tyrell. We're asking you to live.

They roll. Arianna stays behind a moment, staring at the bloody shirt on the floor.

9 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NEUROSURGERY PRE-OP BAY - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 7:44 AM

BOOKER HAINES (64), retired A-train conductor, sits on a gurney in a gown, the right side of his face unshaven, the left side clean-shaven. He holds his jaw very still, as if it were made of glass. His wife, MAE HAINES (62), holds his other hand. Esther reviews the consent.

ESTHER
Mr. Haines. Dr. Graves is going to make a small opening behind your right ear and look at the nerve that carries feeling to your face. If a blood vessel is pressing on it, he'll move it and put a tiny cushion in between.

BOOKER
(barely moving his lips)
And if there's no vessel?

ESTHER
(beat)
Then we'll talk about other options. (beat) But on your MRI, it looks like there's a vessel.

Booker nods, very carefully. Even nodding hurts.

MAE
(quietly)
He hasn't let me kiss that side of his face since 1993. (beat) He hasn't shaved it since 1999. Says the razor is like a blowtorch.

BOOKER
(through his teeth)
Twelve years. (beat)
Carbamazepine. Gabapentin.
Baclofen. Two injections. A
doctor in Forest Hills who burned
the nerve with a needle and it
came back worse. (beat) I kept
saying, "Maybe it'll stop on its
own."

ESTHER
(gently)
What made you come in now?

BOOKER
(beat)
My granddaughter tried to kiss me
goodnight in August. (beat) I
screamed at her. She's five.
(beat) She asked her mother what
she did wrong.

Mae squeezes his hand. Booker looks at Esther.

BOOKER
(simply)
Enough.

Esther holds his gaze. Then she hands him the pen. He signs.

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF OF CARDIOTHORACIC SURGERY'S OFFICE - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 8:02 AM

Robert behind his desk. Amond stands in front of it like a soldier.

ROBERT
Sit down, Dr. Baker.

AMOND
I'm fine standing.

ROBERT
(evenly)
Sit down before you fall down.

Amond sits.

ROBERT
(beat)
Any blood?

AMOND
(beat)
No.

ROBERT
Fever?

AMOND
No.

ROBERT
Pain?

AMOND
(beat)
Some.

ROBERT
On a scale of one to ten. And don't you dare say three.

AMOND
(beat)
Five. (beat) Six, when I bend over. (beat) It's the same. It's not worse. Lowery said fever, black stool or syncope. I have none of those. I'm following the plan.

Robert studies him for a long moment.

ROBERT
(quietly)
Eleven days, Dr. Baker. October fourteenth. (beat) You know what Barry Marshall did, to prove that bacteria caused ulcers?

AMOND
(beat)
He drank a culture of H. pylori.

ROBERT
He made himself sick to prove he was right. (beat) And today they gave him the Nobel Prize. (beat) Don't get the wrong lesson from that, son. They don't give Nobel Prizes for being stubborn. They give them for being right. (beat) You're not right. You're just stubborn.

Amond looks at the floor.

ROBERT
(standing)
Go meet Mrs. Lemieux. She's going to want to hug the man who carried her son's heart. Let her.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 3 - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 8:14 AM

Tyrell's belly is open. Blood everywhere. Elxa operates from a tall stool, her pregnant belly pressed against the table's edge. Raven assists. Arianna runs suction. The liver is torn: a deep, ragged laceration through the right lobe, pumping.

ELXA
Grade four. Pringle. Ellison, put your hand through the foramen of Winslow and squeeze the portal triad. Like you're holding a garden hose closed.

Raven slides her hand behind the ligament and squeezes. The bleeding slows to an ooze.

ARIANNA
(suctioning)
The bullet's still in there. Posterior. Sitting against the vena cava.

ELXA
Then we leave it there. (beat) We don't go chasing bullets next to the cava, Dr. Cummings. We stop the bleeding, pack the liver and get out. Damage control. He comes back in forty-eight hours, warm and full of blood, and then we finish.

They work. Long minutes. Elxa sutures the deepest bleeders. Raven's hand trembles from the squeeze but doesn't let go.

ARIANNA
(low, suctioning)
Three times. Sixteen years old, and somebody's shot him three times.

ELXA
(not looking up)
Four, if you count the one that killed his mother. (beat) Tee told me in the hallway. Same corner. 2001. (beat) Laps.

Arianna hands her the laparotomy pads. Elxa packs them around the liver, one after another.

ARIANNA
(very quiet)
My brother Ahmad's twenty. He stood on a corner on Broadway in Gary for two years. (beat) Every time my phone rang at night, I thought it was this.

RAVEN
(gently)
What changed?

ARIANNA
(beat)
My mom got sick enough that somebody had to stay home with her. (beat) He's the somebody now. (beat) Sometimes the thing that saves you is the worst thing that happened to you.

Elxa glances up at Arianna over her mask. Then down again.

ELXA
Pringle off. Eight thirty-one. (beat) Sixteen minutes. Good hands, Ellison. (beat) Now let's see if he lives.

12 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FAMILY LOUNGE - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 8:40 AM

MRS. LULA PICKENS (64), in a MetroCard-booth clerk's uniform with her name tag still on, sits rigid in a chair. Beside her, KORDELL PICKENS (11), Tyrell's little brother,

in a school uniform, swinging his legs. Harmony comes in.

HARMONY
Mrs. Pickens? I'm Dr. Divine. Tyrell's in surgery. The bullet hit his liver. Dr. Bullock stopped the bleeding. He's alive.

Mrs. Pickens closes her eyes. Her lips move. A prayer, or a count.

LULA
(eyes still closed)
Third time.

HARMONY
(sitting beside her)
I know.

LULA
(opening her eyes)
No, baby. You don't. (beat) I buried my daughter in 2001. Twenty-nine years old. Same bench. Same corner. (beat) Then I took these two boys. I worked a double at the token booth every day so they'd have shoes. Took them to church every Sunday. Tyrell sang in the youth choir. (beat) He got shot the first time at thirteen. Walking home from choir practice.

Kordell has stopped swinging his legs.

LULA
(quiet, final)
Enough. (beat) I'm saying it now. Out loud. In front of God and you and this baby. (she puts her hand on Kordell's head) Enough is enough. (beat) My sister has a house in Rocky Mount, North Carolina. Three bedrooms. A porch. A Baptist church you can walk to. (beat) When Tyrell can stand up, we're going. All three of us. I don't care what it costs.

HARMONY
(beat)
He might not want to go.

LULA
(beat)
He's sixteen. He doesn't get a vote on whether he lives.

13 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 6 - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 9:05 AM

NADIA ELLERBE (28), an MTA bus driver, twenty-six weeks pregnant with a belly much too large for twenty-six weeks, lies propped up, puffy-faced, a blood pressure cuff cycling. Her husband, MALIK ELLERBE (30), a Con Ed lineman, holds her hand. Clayton, Crump and Marc stand at the foot of the bed. Natasha watches from the doorway.

CLAYTON
Mrs. Ellerbe. Your son's tumor is stealing his blood, and his heart is starting to fail. And your body is starting to copy his: the swelling, the blood pressure. That's called mirror syndrome. (beat) If we don't operate, we will probably lose him. And if this keeps going, it gets dangerous for you, too.

NADIA
(holding her belly)
And if you operate?

CRUMP
(gently)
We open your womb. We bring out just his bottom, the part with the tumor. We take out as much of the tumor as we can. We put him back. We close you. (beat) He goes on growing inside you, we hope, for as long as we can keep you pregnant.

MALIK
(staring)
You take him out and put him back?

MARC
(beat)
Only half of him, Mr. Ellerbe. (beat) The rest of him never leaves.

Malik looks at Marc. Somehow that's the thing that makes it real.

NADIA
(beat)
What are the odds?

CLAYTON
(honest)
This has been done fewer than two dozen times in the world. (beat) Maybe half the babies survive. The risks to you are real: bleeding, infection, early labor. Every pregnancy after this one will be a C-section. (beat) I won't pretend it's anything but a hard choice.

Nadia looks at Natasha in the doorway.

NADIA
(to Natasha)
You're the Chief?

NATASHA
I am.

NADIA
(beat)
Would you let them do it to you?

Natasha is quiet a moment. She looks at Clayton. At Crump. At Marc.

NATASHA
(simply)
I'd let these three. Yes.

Clayton glances at her. Marc doesn't look at his mother. Nadia squeezes Malik's hand.

NADIA
(beat)
Okay. (beat) Okay. Save him.

14 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC CARE UNIT - BED 6 - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 9:48 AM

Curtis sits up in bed. The door opens. ODILE LEMIEUX (69), tiny, fierce, in a church hat and a donated Astros windbreaker, with a Delta bag and a mason jar, stands in the doorway. Curtis bursts into tears.

CURTIS
Mama.

She crosses the room faster than a 69-year-old should be able to and takes her son's face in both hands.

ODILE
(kissing his forehead over and over)
Look at you. Look at you. Pink as a baby.

She turns. Amond is standing at the foot of the bed with the chart, trying very hard to be invisible. Odile looks him up and down.

ODILE
(narrowing her eyes)
You the baby doctor?

AMOND
(beat)
I'm Dr. Baker, ma'am.

ODILE
Two hundred and some phone calls. Lionel showed me the phone. (beat) Come here.

AMOND
Ma'am, I...

ODILE
Boy, I chopped through a roof with a hatchet. Don't make me come over there.

Amond comes. Odile wraps him in a hug. He stands rigid in her arms. Then, slowly, his hands come up and rest on her back.

ODILE
(into his shoulder)
Thank you for my son.

When she lets go, she presses the mason jar into his hands. Fig preserves.

ODILE
From my sister's tree in Baton Rouge. The only thing of mine the water didn't get.

Amond holds the jar. He can't speak. Then a spasm of pain crosses his face, and his free hand goes to his side before he can stop it. Odile's eyes follow it.

ODILE
(sharp)
You sick, baby doctor.

AMOND
(straightening)
No, ma'am.

ODILE
(beat)
I raised two boys. I know what a lie looks like coming out of a pretty mouth.

15 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 6 - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 10:20 AM

Booker Haines lies face down in a Mayfield head clamp. A small opening behind his right ear. Graves at the microscope, Esther across from him at the side scope. Deep in the opening, under the bright light: the trigeminal nerve, a pale cord, and draped across it, pulsing, a loop of artery.

GRAVES
Superior cerebellar artery. Lying right across the root entry zone of the fifth nerve. (beat) Every heartbeat, it hits the nerve. Seventy times a minute for twelve years.

ESTHER
(watching)
He said it's like being struck by lightning when he brushes his teeth.

GRAVES
They call it the suicide disease. (beat) Teflon.

The scrub nurse hands him a tiny shredded pad of Teflon felt. Graves teases the artery gently off the nerve and slides the felt between them, like a pillow.

GRAVES
There. (beat) The artery can pound all it likes now. The nerve won't feel it.

A long beat of quiet work.

GRAVES
(not looking up)
You've been counting, Dr. Smilley.

ESTHER
(beat)
Sir?

GRAVES
Your chart notes. Every one is dated, and then there's a small number in the corner. Twenty. Twenty-one. Twenty-two. (beat) I assumed it was a countdown.

Esther's hands stop for half a second. Then keep working.

ESTHER
(quiet)
Thirty days. (beat) Today's twenty-two.

GRAVES
(beat)
And what happens on thirty?

ESTHER
(beat)
I have to know.

GRAVES
(beat, irrigating)
In twenty-six years of neurosurgery, Dr. Smilley, I have learned one thing about pain. (beat) You can pad it. Or you can take away what's causing it. (beat) Padding works for a while. (beat) Close the dura.

16 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ELEVATOR 4 - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 11:12 AM

The old brass elevator. Marc steps in with an armful of fetal surgery consent forms. The doors start to close. A hand stops them. Esther. She sees him. She hesitates. She steps in.

The doors close. The cranky motor groans. They stand side by side, facing forward, two feet apart.

ESTHER
(finally)
I heard you're doing an open fetal.

MARC
(facing forward)
Two o'clock.

ESTHER
(beat)
That's amazing, Marc.

A long silence. The elevator crawls.

MARC
(still facing forward)
You called at two-ten this morning.

Esther closes her eyes.

MARC
And at one-fifty on Thursday. And at two-thirty last Monday. (beat) It rings once and stops. (beat) I don't pick up. You know I don't pick up. And you call anyway.

ESTHER
(barely)
I'm sorry.

MARC
(turning to look at her, finally)
Es. (beat) Enough.

She looks at him.

MARC
(quiet, steady)
You asked him for thirty days. You asked me to let you have them. (beat) So take them. All of them. Without me in them. (beat) No more hallway looks. No more one-ring calls at two in the morning. No more standing at the other end of the Board so I can feel you not looking at me. (beat) I can't live like a man waiting for a phone to ring. (beat) Enough.

The elevator dings. The doors open on eleven. Neither moves.

ESTHER
(finally, very quietly)
Okay.

MARC
(stepping out, then turning back)
And Esther? (beat) Whatever you decide on day thirty. (beat) Decide it for you. Not for him. And not for me.

The doors close between them.

17 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 11:40 AM

MRS. EVANGELINE TRUITT (70), in a lilac suit and pearls, sits across from Natasha with a cup of tea she's holding mostly for show.

MRS. TRUITT
Horace called me at nine-fifteen. (beat) He wants me to second his motion at the board on the twentieth. A full review of the Foundation's relationships with Queens Grace staff. Gifts, grants, visits. (beat) He was very charming. He complimented my hat.

NATASHA
(dry)
He compliments everyone's hat, Evangeline.

MRS. TRUITT
(sipping)
I told him I'd think about it. (beat) I thought about it for twenty minutes, in the back of my car on the Queensboro Bridge. (beat) I'm thinking no.

NATASHA
(beat)
Thank you.

MRS. TRUITT
(setting down the cup)
Don't thank me. Count. (beat) Horace has three votes already, Natasha. Hollingsworth, Edmonds and the new man from the bank. You have three. That leaves Reverend Ashworth and Judge Kittredge. (beat) And the Judge does not like your father.

Natasha is silent.

MRS. TRUITT
(gently)
Horace isn't stupid. He doesn't know what he's looking for yet. (beat) He's looking for a loading dock and a Town Car and a reason. (beat) Make sure he doesn't find a boy.

NATASHA
(very quietly)
He won't.

MRS. TRUITT
(rising, patting her hand)
Your son spilled punch on the Ambassador to Ghana at your father's Christmas party in 1990, Natasha, and I told the whole room it was me. (beat) I've been covering for that child for fifteen years. I'm not about to stop for Horace Whitlow.

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 6 - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 12:38 PM

Nadia's monitor alarms. Her blood pressure: 172 over 112. A NURSE calls out. Marc, at the desk outside, is there in two seconds. Then Clayton.

NURSE
One seventy-two over one twelve. She says her head's pounding.

NADIA
(holding her head)
It feels like my head's in a vise.

CLAYTON
(checking the fetal monitor)
Fetal heart rate's one-ninety. He's tachycardic. (beat) The mirror's accelerating.

MARC
Magnesium, four grams, for seizure prophylaxis. Labetalol, twenty IV. (to the nurse) And call the OR. (to Clayton) We can't wait until two.

CLAYTON
(looking at him, then nodding)
No. We can't. (into the wall phone) This is Hartwell. I need OR Five for the open fetal now. Page Dr. Crump. Page the Chief. Fetal anesthesia, NICU, all of it. (beat) Now.

Malik grabs Marc's arm.

MALIK
What's happening?

MARC
(steady)
Your son's heart is failing faster, and your wife's body is following. (beat) We're going now, Mr. Ellerbe. Kiss her.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 5 - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 1:21 PM

The biggest OR in the hospital, and the most crowded. Two anesthesiologists. A NICU team in the corner with a tiny isolette, just in case. Nadia under deep general anesthesia. Her belly is open, and her uterus, huge and blue-veined, has been lifted out onto her abdomen. Clayton has mapped the placenta by ultrasound and made a careful incision in the uterine wall, away from it, sealed with absorbable staples. Warm fluid runs into the uterus through a tube to keep it full.

And through the opening: a baby's bottom and legs, impossibly small, and attached to the base of the spine, the tumor. Purple, lobulated, half the size of the baby.

CLAYTON
Fetus is out to the waist. Fetal echo?

FETAL CARDIOLOGIST
Heart rate one-seventy. Squeezing hard. He's working.

CRUMP
(at the tumor, Marc across from him)
Tourniquet around the base. Dr. Bullock, hold the mass while I place it. Gently. It's mostly blood vessels, and it will bleed like a fire hose.

Marc cradles the tumor in his gloved hands. It's almost as big as his palm. Crump loops a tourniquet around its base.

CRUMP
Tightening.

On the fetal echo, the heart rate jumps, then drops. 160. 140. 110.

FETAL CARDIOLOGIST
Bradycardia. Ninety. (beat)
Eighty.

CLAYTON
(fast)
Increase the warm infusion.
Atropine on the field. (beat) Why
is he dropping?

Everyone looks at the monitors. Marc looks at the baby. Then down, past the baby's legs, to where they disappear back into the uterus. A loop of umbilical cord, pinched between the edge of the uterine incision and the retractor.

MARC
(calm, quick)
Cord. (beat) The cord's under the
lower retractor blade. It's
compressed.

Clayton's eyes follow Marc's finger. He sees it. He eases the retractor back a centimeter. The cord, freed, plumps back to its full width.

FETAL CARDIOLOGIST
(beat)
Heart rate coming up. One-ten.
One-thirty. One-fifty-five.

A collective breath in the room. Clayton looks across the field at Marc. A long beat.

CLAYTON
(quietly)
Good catch, Dr. Bullock.

MARC
(eyes back on the
tumor)
Thank you, Dr. Hartwell.

CRUMP
(dryly)
Charming. Now, gentlemen. A tumor.

Crump resects the tumor, fast, his old hands sure, Marc tying and cauterizing as he goes. The purple mass comes free and goes into a basin. It's enormous next to the baby.

CRUMP
Debulked. (beat) Now put him home.

Clayton gently guides the baby's bottom and legs back through the incision into the warm fluid. Then he closes the uterus in layers.

CLAYTON
(closing)
Twenty-six weeks and one day. (beat) Stay in there, little man. As long as you can.

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC CARE UNIT - BED 6 - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 2:05 PM

Robert reads the pathology report. Curtis, Odile and Amond wait.

ROBERT
ISHLT grade three-A. Moderate acute cellular rejection. (beat) Your immune system has found the new heart, Mr. Lemieux, and it's started to attack.

ODILE
(gripping Curtis's hand)
Lord.

ROBERT
(calmly)
This is common. One of the most common things that happens in the first month. It's treatable. Three days of high-dose IV steroids. Solu-Medrol, a gram a day. We repeat the biopsy next week. (beat) The heart is still working beautifully. We caught it early, because we looked early.

Amond takes a step forward to hang the first dose. He sways. Just a little. Odile, sitting nearest, puts out one hand and grabs his wrist with a grip that has chopped through a roof.

ODILE
(quietly, not letting go)
Sit down, baby doctor.

AMOND
(beat)
I'm fine, ma'am.

ODILE
(to Robert, without looking away from Amond)
Doctor. This boy's been gray since nine o'clock this morning. (beat) Somebody in this room is lying, and it isn't me.

Robert sets down the report. Looks at Amond. Amond looks back.

ROBERT
(very quietly)
Hang the steroids, Dr. Baker. (beat) And then you're going to have a blood count drawn. In front of me.

AMOND
(beat)
Yes, sir.

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL INTENSIVE CARE UNIT - BED 3 - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 2:40 PM

Tyrell, intubated earlier and now extubated, his belly packed and covered with a temporary closure, groggy. DET. LAWRENCE FYFFE (38), 113th Precinct, in a rumpled suit, stands at the foot of the bed with a notebook. Arianna stands by the monitors with her arms crossed.

DET. FYFFE
Tyrell. Third time, man. Same bench. (beat) Who was it?

TYRELL
(hoarse)
Didn't see.

DET. FYFFE
You didn't see the first time. You didn't see the second time. (beat) You're the blindest sixteen-year-old in South Jamaica.

TYRELL
(turning his head away)
I got a little brother.

The detective sighs, flips the notebook closed and hands Arianna a card.

DET. FYFFE
If he gets his sight back. (he leaves)

Arianna pulls a chair up to the bed and sits.

ARIANNA
I'm not a cop.

TYRELL
(eyes closed)
I know. You the one with the suction.

ARIANNA
(beat)
I'm the one from Gary, Indiana. (beat) My brother's name is Ahmad. He's twenty. He stood on a corner on Broadway for two years. (beat) You know what saved him?

TYRELL
(beat, eyes still closed)
Jesus?

ARIANNA
(almost laughing)
Our mother got sick. Bad sick. Somebody had to stay home and keep her alive. (beat) He hated it. Every single day. (beat) He's alive.

Tyrell opens his eyes and looks at her.

ARIANNA
(quiet)
Your grandmother's going to ask you to leave New York. (beat) You're going to hate it. (beat) Go anyway.

TYRELL
(beat)
What's in North Carolina?

ARIANNA
(standing)
A porch, I hear. (beat) And you, at seventeen.

22 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 5 - SCRUB ROOM - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 3:44 PM

Clayton and Marc at adjacent sinks, scrubbing off. Exhausted. Neither talks for a long moment.

CLAYTON
(finally)
I've done this operation three times now. (beat) I've never seen the cord compress like that. Neither had Crump. (beat) You were looking at the baby when the rest of us were looking at the monitors.

MARC
(drying his hands)
The monitor tells you what's happening. The baby tells you why.

CLAYTON
(beat)
You're very good, Bullock.

MARC
(beat)
So are you.

CLAYTON
(a tired, honest half-smile)
That's inconvenient for both of us.

MARC
(tossing the paper towel)
Yeah. It is.

Marc goes. Clayton keeps scrubbing hands that are already clean, thinking.

23 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 3:55 PM

Harmony at her open locker, pulling out a clean scrub top. Esther comes in, sees her and almost leaves. Then doesn't. She sits on the bench. A long silence.

ESTHER
(quietly)
Can I ask you something?

HARMONY
(not turning around)
You can ask.

ESTHER
(beat)
On the stairs. September eighth. When you told me to go find him. (beat) You said you wanted him to be happy. "Even if it's with you." (beat) Harmony. Are you in love with him?

Harmony's hands stop on the scrub top. She doesn't turn around. On the top shelf of the locker, behind her church shoes, the edge of a folded piece of notebook paper.

HARMONY
(finally, very quiet)
Enough, Esther.

ESTHER
(beat)
That's not an answer.

HARMONY
(turning around, eyes bright and hard)
It's the only one you get. (beat) You have eight days left of your thirty. (beat) You don't get to spend any of them on me.

She closes the locker. Pulls the scrub top on over her head. Walks out. Esther sits alone on the bench.

24 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NEUROSURGERY FLOOR - ROOM 512 - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 4:20 PM

Booker Haines, awake, a bandage behind his ear. Mae sits beside him. Esther comes in with a chart.

ESTHER
Mr. Haines. How's the pain?

Booker hesitates. Slowly, carefully, as if handling a live wire, he raises a hand and touches his right cheek. Then his lip. Then his jaw. He waits for the lightning. Nothing comes.

BOOKER
(whispering)
Nothing. (beat) Mae. There's nothing.

Mae puts her hand over her mouth. Booker touches his face again, harder. Then he rubs it with his whole palm, the way a man rubs his face when he wakes up, a thing he hasn't been able to do in twelve years.

BOOKER
(crying now)
Twelve years. I couldn't kiss my wife on that side. Couldn't eat a cold apple. I shaved half my face. (beat) Dr. Smilley, I wanted to die. Twice I almost did it.

Esther sets down the chart.

BOOKER
(to Esther)
I kept waiting for it to stop on its own. Twelve years of waiting. (beat) Don't you ever wait twelve years on anything, young lady. (beat) Have the operation.

Esther stands very still. Then she smiles at him, really smiles, for the first time all day.

ESTHER
(quietly)
Yes, sir.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ON-CALL ROOM 2 - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 4:51 PM

Elxa lies on the bottom bunk with her feet up on three pillows. Marc sits on the floor with his back against the bunk, still in OR scrubs, his eyes closed.

ELXA
I heard. Cord compression. Crump told Gloria and Gloria told the world.

MARC
(eyes closed)
Hartwell called it a good catch.

ELXA
(beat)
How did that feel?

MARC
(beat)
Terrible. (beat) And then great. (beat) And then terrible again for being great.

ELXA
(laughing)
That's a whole residency in one sentence. (beat) Give me your hand.

MARC
(opening his eyes)
Again?

ELXA
Just do it.

He reaches up. She presses his palm flat on the side of her belly. They wait. A beat. Two.

A thump. Unmistakable. Right against his hand.

MARC
(sitting up, eyes wide)
That was...

ELXA
(grinning)
From the outside. Like I promised. A month later. Twenty-one and a half weeks.

Another thump. Marc laughs out loud, a big, startled, delighted sound.

MARC
(to the belly)
Hey. Hey, you. That's your uncle. (beat) You kick like a running back.

ELXA
(softly, watching his face)
There he is. (beat) I haven't seen that face since August.

Marc keeps his hand there. The baby kicks again.

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - JACKSON AVENUE ENTRANCE - LOBBY - DAY
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 5:46 PM

Rush hour. Clayton, in his blazer, waits by the revolving door, checking his watch. Esther comes out of the elevator in a coat with her bag. She walks to him. They leave together through the revolving door, not touching, two people going to the same appointment.

Up on the mezzanine, by the window above the lobby, Marc stands with a cup of coffee. He watches them go. He doesn't move.

Behind him, Gloria, passing with a chart, pauses.

GLORIA
(quietly)
Baby. (beat) You told her enough.

MARC
(not turning)
I did.

GLORIA
(beat)
Then stop watching the door.
(beat) Enough goes both ways.

She keeps walking. Marc looks at the empty revolving door a moment longer. Then he turns his back on it.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

27 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SECURITY OFFICE - NIGHT
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 6:08 PM

A cramped room of CCTV monitors and a coffee maker older than most of the interns. Big Ray (45) sits at the desk. Natasha stands in the doorway. He gets up when he sees her.

BIG RAY
Chief.

NATASHA
Sit, Ray.

He doesn't. She closes the door.

BIG RAY
(quietly)
Dr. Whitlow sent a request to my supervisor at two o'clock. Copies of the loading dock log and the camera footage for August ninth, from four to six a.m. (beat) He came down himself at four. Asked me, very friendly, who I escorted that morning.

NATASHA
(beat)
And what did you tell him?

BIG RAY
That I escort a lot of people, Chief. Some of them don't like their names on paper. (beat) He smiled. He said he'd see the footage.

NATASHA
(beat)
The footage.

BIG RAY
(beat)
The loading dock camera's been broken since July. Work order's on file. I've asked them to fix it four times. (beat) I didn't break it, Chief. I'm saying that now, so you never have to wonder.

NATASHA
(quietly)
I never would, Ray.

BIG RAY
(beat)
And Chief. If they ever put me under oath, about anything, I'll tell the truth. (beat) I was twenty years NYPD. I don't lie under oath.

NATASHA
(meeting his eyes)
I would never ask you to. (beat) Not for me. Not for my father. (beat) Not for my son.

Big Ray nods once. That settles something between them.

28 INT. BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - DR. GREENIDGE'S OFFICE - NIGHT
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 6:34 PM

A brownstone parlor-floor office on Montague Street: two armchairs, a sofa, a fern, a window onto the Promenade and the lights of Lower Manhattan. DR. PAULETTE GREENIDGE (50), locs pulled back, cardigan, a voice like warm tea, sits in one armchair. Esther sits at one end of the sofa. Clayton at the other. A careful three feet between them.

DR. GREENIDGE
Session seven. (beat) Last Thursday, Esther, you said there was a question you'd been afraid to ask. (beat) Are you ready to ask it?

Esther looks at her hands. Then at Clayton.

ESTHER
(quietly)
February eleventh. (beat) Was it one night?

Clayton's face doesn't move. But he takes a long time. Too long.

DR. GREENIDGE
(gently)
Clayton.

CLAYTON
(finally, evenly)
No.

Esther closes her eyes.

CLAYTON
(beat)
It started on New Year's Eve. At the party in Milton. (beat) It ended on February eleventh, because you came home early. (beat) Six weeks.

ESTHER
(barely)
Six weeks.

CLAYTON
(looking at her)
I could have said "one night." You'd have believed me. (beat) I've had twenty-two days to say "one night." (beat) I'm not going to lie to you in the room where we agreed not to lie.

ESTHER
(opening her eyes, shaking)
Six weeks of coming home to me. Of sleeping next to me. Of eating my mother's Sunday dinners with Malcolm across the table.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Yes.

Silence. Dr. Greenidge lets it sit.

DR. GREENIDGE
(softly)
Esther. What are you feeling right now? One word.

ESTHER
(beat)
Stupid.

DR. GREENIDGE
(beat)
And Clayton?

CLAYTON
(beat, the polish gone)
Ashamed.

DR. GREENIDGE
(gently)
Those are the first two true words either of you has said to the other in seven sessions. (beat) We'll stop there tonight.

29 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL INTENSIVE CARE UNIT - BED 3 - NIGHT
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 6:44 PM

Tyrell, awake, propped up. Lula sits beside him. Kordell sits on the end of the bed with a bag of Doritos. Raven checks the drains.

LULA
(holding Tyrell's hand)
Rocky Mount. Aunt Bernadine's. Three bedrooms and a porch. (beat) As soon as Dr. Bullock lets you out.

TYRELL
(weak)
Grandma, I don't know nobody in North Carolina.

LULA
That's the point, baby. (beat) Nobody in North Carolina knows you either. (beat) You get to start over.

Tyrell looks at Kordell. Kordell looks back, eleven years old, with Dorito dust on his fingers.

KORDELL
(quietly)
Aunt Bernadine has a dog. (beat) And there's a creek.

Tyrell looks at his brother for a long time. Then at Raven.

TYRELL
(to Raven)
The doctor with the suction said go anyway.

RAVEN
(smiling)
Dr. Cummings. (beat) She's usually right. Don't tell her I said that.

TYRELL
(beat, to Lula)
Okay. (beat) Okay, Grandma.

Lula puts her face down on his hand and cries. Kordell throws his arms around his brother very carefully, avoiding the belly. Raven slips out.

30 EXT. BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - MONTAGUE STREET - NIGHT
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 7:22 PM

The sidewalk outside the brownstone. Esther walks fast toward the subway at Court Street. Clayton catches up and walks beside her, not touching.

CLAYTON
Es.

ESTHER
(not stopping)
Don't.

CLAYTON
I told you the truth.

ESTHER
(stopping, rounding on him)
You told me the truth on day twenty-two, Clayton. You've been sitting across from me for twenty-two days, letting me think it was one stupid night.

CLAYTON
(beat, quietly)
Yes. (beat) And how many nights did you sit across from him?

That lands like a slap. Esther stares at him.

CLAYTON
(gently, which is worse)
I'm not saying it to hurt you. I'm saying it because it's true. (beat) We're the same kind of coward, Es. That's what's so terrible about it. (beat) We both thought if we waited long enough, the truth would get easier to say.

Esther looks at him for a long moment. Then she turns and walks down the subway stairs alone. Clayton stands on the sidewalk under the streetlight. He doesn't follow.

31 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - NIGHT
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 7:58 PM

A Monday crowd. The Yankees-Angels preview on TV, the division series opening tomorrow. In the corner booth: Marc, Raven, Arianna and Amond, who has a club soda and the mason jar of fig preserves on the table in front of him like a trophy.

RAVEN
(pointing at the jar)
You brought preserves to a bar.

AMOND
A sixty-nine-year-old woman who chopped through a roof gave them to me. I'm not leaving them in a locker.

ARIANNA
(taking a spoon from a cup of coffee stirrers and digging in)
They're good.

AMOND
(snatching the jar back)
Cummings.

Monty (42) brings a round.

MONTY
Doc. (to Amond) Your blood count come back?

AMOND
(surprised)
How do you know about my...

MONTY
(tapping his ear)
Bar.

AMOND
(beat)
Twelve point one. (beat) It's within normal limits.

MARC
(frowning)
What was it in July?

AMOND
(beat)
Fourteen point six.

Marc and Arianna exchange a look. Amond pointedly drinks his club soda.

A WOMAN at the bar, DANIELLA (27), pretty, in a Fordham Law sweatshirt, catches Marc's eye and smiles. She comes over.

DANIELLA
(to Marc)
You're the doctor from the blog. Dr. X.

MARC
(polite)
I'm a doctor. Blogs are fiction.

DANIELLA
(smiling)
Can I buy Fiction a drink?

Raven and Arianna both lean in, very interested. Marc smiles at Daniella, a real smile, kind.

MARC
(gently)
That's really nice of you. (beat) But I'm not in a good place to be anybody's anything right now. (beat) You'd deserve better than half my attention.

DANIELLA
(beat, a little surprised, then nodding)
That's the nicest no I've ever gotten. (beat) Good luck, Fiction.

She goes back to the bar. Raven stares at Marc.

ARIANNA
(to Raven, low)
He's going to be a monk. We're going to lose him to a monastery.

RAVEN
(to Arianna, low, grinning)
You'd visit.

ARIANNA
(beat, grinning back despite herself)
I'd bring beer.

Their eyes hold for half a second longer than usual. Then they both look away. Amond, who notices everything, notices that.

32 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - RIVERSIDE DRIVE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 8:34 PM

Robert at the stove in an apron, stirring something in a cast-iron pot. Natasha at the kitchen island with a legal pad, columns of names.

NATASHA
Three for Horace. Three for me. Reverend Ashworth and Judge Kittredge undecided. (beat) The Judge hasn't forgiven Daddy for the Columbia gift in 1994.

She puts the pen down.

NATASHA
Ray told me the loading dock camera's been broken since July. Work order on file. (beat) Horace won't find anything.

ROBERT
(beat, turning off the burner)
Tasha.

NATASHA
What?

ROBERT
(gently)
He won't find anything this time. (beat) The boy's twenty-six. He's going to be a surgeon in this hospital for the next twenty years. (beat) One day somebody finds out. Horace or a reporter or a nurse with a good memory. (beat) Wouldn't you rather it was Marc who told them?

NATASHA
(beat, quietly)
That's his decision. Not ours.

ROBERT
(beat)
Then let's make sure he knows it's his. (beat) Not your father's. Not the policy's. His.

Natasha looks at her husband for a long moment.

NATASHA
(beat)
What are you making?

ROBERT
(taking down two bowls)
Your mother's red beans. (beat) For Odile Lemieux. She's at the Holiday Inn on Queens Boulevard eating vending machine crackers. (beat) I'm taking it over at ten.

Natasha watches him ladle beans into a container. She gets up, finds the cornbread and wraps it in foil without a word.

33 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 6 - NIGHT
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 8:52 PM

Nadia, post-op, asleep, a magnesium drip running. Her monitor reads 138 over 88. The fetal heart monitor beats steadily: 148. Malik sits beside her. Marc checks the incision dressing and the uterine monitor.

MALIK
(quietly)
One-thirty-eight. That's better, right?

MARC
That's much better. (beat) The mirror's breaking. Her body's stopped copying his. (beat) No contractions. His heart rate's one-forty-eight. That's perfect.

Malik nods. He takes a folded paper from his wallet: a sonogram printout, worn soft.

MALIK
(unfolding it)
Twelve weeks. Before anybody knew. (beat) We named him already. Malik Junior. (beat) Nadia says that's too much pressure for a baby. I said, "He's already been operated on twice the age of a sandwich. He can take it."

MARC
(laughing)
Twice the age of a sandwich?

MALIK
(grinning, tired)
I'm a lineman, Doc. I'm not a poet.

A beat. Malik looks at Marc.

MALIK
(serious)
Dr. Hartwell told me you caught the cord. (beat) He didn't have to tell me that. He told me anyway.

Marc doesn't know what to do with that. He nods.

MARC
(quietly)
He's a good surgeon, Mr. Ellerbe.

MALIK
(beat)
So are you. (beat) I heard he said that too.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

34 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - NURSES' STATION - NIGHT
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 9:14 PM

Clayton, back from Brooklyn, in his blazer, reviewing Nadia's chart at the station. Dr. Horace Whitlow walks up, all smiles and silver hair.

WHITLOW
Dr. Hartwell. Horace Whitlow. Chief of Medicine. (offering his hand) I've been hoping to meet our new star. An open fetal in your fourth week. They're talking about it on twelve.

CLAYTON
(shaking his hand, pleasant)
Dr. Whitlow. Dr. Crump did the hard part.

WHITLOW
(laughing)
And modest. From Boston, even. (beat) The Chief recruited you personally, I understand.

CLAYTON
She did.

WHITLOW
Remarkable woman. Remarkable family. (beat) You must have known the Donohues, in Boston. Brookline, Milton. It's a small world, Black Boston.

CLAYTON
(beat, carefully)
Everyone knows of the Donohues, Dr. Whitlow.

WHITLOW
(smiling)
Of course. (beat) I only ask because I'm putting together a little history for the board. Of the Foundation and this hospital. Families, connections. Who's related to whom. (beat) I'd value your perspective sometime. Over lunch. A newcomer sees things the rest of us are too close to notice.

He hands Clayton a business card. Clayton looks at it. Then at Whitlow.

CLAYTON
(pleasantly)
I'm a fetal surgeon, Dr. Whitlow. (beat) I only notice things that are still inside.

WHITLOW
(laughing warmly)
Lunch, then. (beat) Whenever you like.

Whitlow walks away down the corridor. Clayton turns the card over in his fingers. Then he puts it in his breast pocket. Not in the trash. In his pocket.

35 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC CARE UNIT - BED 6 - NIGHT
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 9:38 PM

The unit is dim. Curtis sleeps, the steroid infusion running. Odile sits beside him, humming softly: "Just a Closer Walk with Thee." Amond, in a fresh scrub top with his coat over his arm, stops in the doorway on his way out.

ODILE
(without turning around)
Go home, baby doctor.

AMOND
I'm going.

ODILE
(turning)
And go to a doctor that ain't you.

Amond looks at her.

AMOND
(beat)
Eleven days, ma'am. I have a date for the surgery.

ODILE
(beat)
Eleven days. (she shakes her head) Baby, I had a date too. The levee was supposed to hold till the year two thousand and fifty. (beat) The water don't read the calendar.

Amond stands in the doorway. He doesn't have an answer. He nods to her, once, and goes.

36 INT. ELXA AND RUSSELL'S HOUSE - ST. ALBANS - BEDROOM - NIGHT
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 9:51 PM

Elxa in bed with her feet on two pillows. RUSSELL JEFFRIES (30) lies beside her with his ear against her belly, grading chemistry quizzes on his chest.

RUSSELL
(muffled)
Nothing.

ELXA
Give it a second.

ELXA
(smiling)
Marc made the face. The August face. (beat) I haven't seen it in a month, Russell.

Thump. Russell sits straight up, scattering quizzes.

RUSSELL
THERE. That one was for me. That was mine.

ELXA
(laughing)
That was yours.

Russell puts both hands on her belly. Elxa watches him.

ELXA
(softer)
My brother told the woman he loves "enough" today. In an elevator. (beat) Gloria saw her come out. (beat) He's going to be okay, isn't he?

RUSSELL
(gently, hands still on her belly)
He told her "enough" and then he felt his nephew kick. (beat) He's going to be okay, El.

37 INT. THE CLARENCE - CABIN - NIGHT
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 10:06 PM

Esther at the galley table, still in her coat. The calendar. Twenty-two red X's. Her RAZR in her hand. She opens a new message to MARC.

> SMS (DRAFT), to MARC: "it wasn't one night. it was six weeks. i found out tonight. i don't know why i'm telling you. i just didn't want to know something you didn't"

Her thumb hovers over SEND. She looks at it for a long time.

"Enough," he said. In the elevator. "Without me in them."

She presses BACK. "Save draft?" She presses NO. The message disappears.

She sets the phone down. Picks up the red pen. Looks at the eight empty days left.

Then she takes Dr. Greenidge's card off the wall and writes on the back, under "Session 7": "Ask myself the question. Not him."

38 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STOOP - NIGHT
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 10:33 PM

Marc sits on the stoop with two mugs of tea. Harmony comes out in a sweatshirt and sits beside him. He hands her one.

HARMONY
You made tea.

MARC
You made grits. It's a whole economy. (beat) The baby kicked. Elxa's. Against my hand.

HARMONY
(lighting up)
Marc!

MARC
(grinning)
Like a running back. (beat) Twenty-one and a half weeks.

She laughs. He laughs. Then they sit, sipping, while the 7 train goes by.

MARC
(beat)
Double-O.

HARMONY
Mm?

MARC
This morning. "That's the most MAN thing I've ever heard. Nobody believed me, so I hurt myself to prove it." (beat) Were you talking about Barry Marshall?

Harmony looks into her tea for a long moment.

HARMONY
(carefully)
I was talking about a lot of people.

MARC
(beat)
Am I one of them?

HARMONY
(beat)
You ran nine miles a day for three weeks to prove you were fine. (beat) So, yes. (beat) And Amond. And Esther, a little. And me, probably.

MARC
(beat)
You?

HARMONY
(standing, taking her mug)
Enough for one night, Marc. (beat) Thank you for the tea.

She goes inside. Marc stays on the stoop, looking at the door she closed behind her, as if it might tell him something.

END OF ACT FIVE

TAG

39 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF OF MEDICINE'S OFFICE - NIGHT
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 11:38 PM

A corner office with mahogany, a framed photo with Mayor Dinkins, and a Penn diploma. Whitlow sits at his desk under a green banker's lamp. In front of him: a photocopy of the loading dock log for August 9, 2005, a QueensGraceConfidential printout ("a VIP came in through the LOADING DOCK at dawn"), and the QGH house staff directory.

MARC (V.O.)
There's a word every surgeon learns in the first week.

Whitlow runs his finger down the log. "04:48 - R. TOLES - ESCORT - VISITOR (UNLOGGED) - DEST: 7 PELL / PEDS ONC." He circles it.

He opens the staff directory to the surgical residents and interns. His finger moves down the list. "BULLOCK, E. - PGY-3." "BULLOCK, M. - PGY-1." He pauses on the second one.

He looks at the name for a long moment. Then he smiles and shakes his head.

WHITLOW
(to himself, amused)
Bullock. (beat) It's a common name.

He closes the directory. But he leaves the log on top of it, with the circle facing up.

MARC (V.O.)
You say it when the suction's full. When the pressure's high enough. When the tissue's about to tear.

40 INT. AMOND'S STUDIO - SUNNYSIDE - BATHROOM - NIGHT
MONDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2005 - 11:52 PM

43rd Street, off Queens Boulevard. A small, spotless bathroom in a bare studio. A medical textbook on the toilet tank. Amond stands at the toilet in a T-shirt and boxers, looking down into the bowl. He is completely still.

We don't see what he sees. We see his face: a surgeon's face, reading a result.

MARC (V.O.)
The hardest thing in medicine isn't knowing what's wrong.

Amond slowly sits down on the edge of the bathtub. He picks up his cell phone from the sink. Scrolls to "BULLOCK, R. - CELL." His thumb hovers over CALL.

MARC (V.O.)
It's saying "enough" to yourself.

He holds it there. Five seconds. Ten.

He puts the phone face down on the sink.

He sits on the edge of the tub in the dark, one hand pressed against his right side, and doesn't call anyone.

MARC (V.O.)
Before your body says it for you.

CUT TO BLACK.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x02

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

NOBELPRIZE.ORG: The Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine 2005

Monday, October 3, 2005

"The Nobel Assembly at Karolinska Institutet has today decided to award the Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for 2005 jointly to Barry J. Marshall and J. Robin Warren for their discovery of the bacterium Helicobacter pylori and its role in gastritis and peptic ulcer disease."

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "BUSH NOMINATES WHITE HOUSE COUNSEL MIERS TO HIGH COURT"

Monday, October 3, 2005

"WASHINGTON (AP) -- President Bush on Monday nominated White House counsel Harriet Miers, a longtime confidante who has never been a judge, to replace retiring Justice Sandra Day O'Connor on the Supreme Court..."

NY1: on-screen chyron

Monday, October 3, 2005, 8:15 AM

"SOUTH JAMAICA: TEEN SHOT NEAR BAISLEY PARK HOUSES; THIRD TIME HE HAS BEEN WOUNDED, POLICE SAY"

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Monday, October 3, 2005, 4:30 PM

"FIRST IN QUEENS: an OPEN FETAL SURGERY at Grace today. They took a 26-week baby halfway out of his mother, removed a tumor the size of a softball and PUT HIM BACK. Our spies in OR 5 say the new Boston surgeon and Dr. X were on the same side of the table, and that Dr. X caught something that 'saved the whole thing.' The new Boston surgeon reportedly said 'good catch.' Out loud. In front of witnesses. We don't know what to do with this information either." Comments (412).

Medical Executive Committee: draft minutes (Bernadette Watkins)

Monday, October 3, 2005, 6:30 AM

Item 4. Dr. Whitlow proposed that the Board of Trustees authorize a review of all Victor Donohue Foundation gifts, visits and relationships with QGH medical staff. Dr. Donohue noted twenty-seven years of Foundation grants predating her appointment. Mr. Bassett advised that the Board must authorize any review. **Action:** to the Board of Trustees, Thursday, October 20, 2005.

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Raven Ellison and Arianna Cummings)

Monday, October 3, 2005, 11:02 PM

Raven: "you were good today. with tyrell"

Arianna: "you held a pringle for 16 min. your hand still shaking?"

Raven: "a little"

Arianna: "ice it"

Raven: "thats it? ice it?"

Arianna: "...and you were good too. go to sleep ellison"

AIM: away message, AortaOrBust79 (Amond Baker)

Monday, October 3, 2005, 11:55 PM

"Asleep."

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x02

New Canon Established

- **Clayton's 30 days** (Sept 12 to Oct 11): day 22 is October 3. Sessions with **Dr. Paulette Greenidge, LCSW-R** (Montague Street, Brooklyn Heights) are Mondays and Thursdays at 6:30 PM; session 7 was October 3. **Revealed:** Clayton and Malcolm Sloan's affair was not one night but **six weeks**, from New Year's Eve 2004 (a party in Milton) to February 11, 2005. Esther: 'Stupid.' Clayton: 'Ashamed.' Clayton: 'We're the same kind of coward.' Esther wrote a draft text telling Marc and didn't send it.
- **Marc's 'Enough'** (11:12 AM, Elevator 4): no more one-ring calls at 2 AM (Esther had called and hung up at least three times), no more hallway looks. 'Decide it for you. Not for him. And not for me.' Marc turned down Daniella at Monty's ('half my attention'). He has run along Gantry Plaza every morning since September 12.
- **Marc and Clayton** did the first open fetal surgery in Queens: resection of a type I sacrococcygeal teratoma at 26 weeks 1 day (Crump; Clayton; Marc). **Marc caught a compressed umbilical cord** under the retractor during fetal bradycardia. Clayton: 'Good catch.' 'You're very good, Bullock.' 'That's inconvenient for both of us.' A professional truce.
- **Dr. Horace Whitlow** (Chief of Medicine) makes his on-screen debut. He moved that the Board review all Foundation relationships with QGH staff; the vote is **Thursday, October 20, 2005**. Count: 3 (Whitlow: Hollingsworth, Edmonds, a new bank trustee) to 3 (Natasha, including Mrs. Truitt), with **Rev. Ashworth and Judge Kittredge undecided**. Kittredge resents Victor over a 1994 Columbia gift. Whitlow requested the August 9 loading dock log and footage. **The dock camera has been broken since July** (work order on file; Big Ray did not break it). Whitlow saw 'BULLOCK, M. - PGY-1' in the directory and dismissed it ('a common name') for now. He gave Clayton his card, and Clayton kept it.
- **Big Ray** will not lie under oath (20 years NYPD), and Natasha will never ask him to. Robert urged that Marc decide when to reveal himself: 'Not your father's. Not the policy's. His.'
- **Amond:** pain 5-6/10. Hgb 12.1, down from 14.6 in July. **11:52 PM: he saw evidence of GI bleeding** (implied melena) and didn't call Robert. Odile: 'The water don't read the calendar.' Arianna, Robert, Lowery and Odile know he's sick; Monty knows about the blood count. **This sets up the Meckel's bleed in 2x03.**
- **Curtis Lemieux:** ISHLT grade 3A acute cellular rejection on his October 3 biopsy, treated with Solu-Medrol 1 g/day for 3 days. Odile Lemieux arrived from Houston (fig preserves from Baton Rouge for Amond), and Robert brought her red beans and cornbread.
- **Elxa** (21.5 weeks): Marc felt the baby kick from the outside, and then Russell did.
- **Harmony and Esther:** asked if she loves Marc, Harmony said 'Enough, Esther.' Harmony to Marc: 'Nobody believed me, so I hurt myself to prove it' was about 'a lot of people,' including Marc, Amond, Esther and herself.
- **Raven and Arianna:** 'You'd visit.' 'I'd bring beer.' Amond noticed.
- **Mrs. Truitt** confirms the 1990 punch story: Marc spilled it, and she took the blame.

Knowledge Tracker (as of October 3, 2005)

Secret	Who knows	New pressure
Marc's family / Victor	Family, Bernie, Graves, Gloria, Mrs. Truitt, Amond, Big Ray, Arianna, Esther	**Whitlow** is investigating the August 9 visit. Clayton suspects; Monty suspects
Affair lasted six weeks	Esther, Clayton, Dr. Greenidge (and Malcolm)	Marc doesn't know
Amond's bleeding	Amond only (as of 11:52 PM)	Robert, Arianna, Odile, Lowery know he's sick
Harmony loves Marc	Raven, Esther (suspects strongly)	Marc is starting to wonder

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Tyrell Pickens	6/7/1989 (16)	GSW right upper quadrant (third GSW); grade IV liver laceration; bullet near the IVC	Damage-control laparotomy, Pringle 16 min, packing (Elxa; Raven, Arianna)	Alive. Second look in 48 h. Family moving to Rocky Mount, NC
Booker Haines	5/16/1941 (64)	Trigeminal neuralgia, V2-V3, 12 years	Microvascular decompression; superior cerebellar artery padded with Teflon (Graves; Esther)	Pain-free
Nadia Ellerbe / fetus	4/25/1977 (28)	Type I sacrococcygeal teratoma, 10 cm, with high-output failure, early hydrops and maternal mirror syndrome	Open fetal debulking at 26w1d (Crump; Clayton; Marc)	Pregnant; BP 138/88; FHR 148
Curtis Lemieux	4/9/1961 (44)	ISHLT 3A acute rejection	Endomyocardial biopsy; pulse Solu-Medrol (Robert; Amond)	Treated; repeat biopsy next week

New Characters

- **Tyrell 'Bird' Pickens** (b. June 7, 1989), **Kordell Pickens** (b. March 2, 1994) and **Lula Pickens** (b. February 11, 1941), an MTA station agent. Tyrell's mother was killed in 2001.
- **Booker Haines** (b. May 16, 1941), a retired A-train conductor, and **Mae Haines** (b. February 8, 1943).
- **Nadia Ellerbe** (b. April 25, 1977), an MTA bus operator; **Malik Ellerbe** (b. January 30, 1975), a Con Ed lineman; fetus 'Malik Jr.'
- **Dr. Paulette Greenidge** (b. August 1, 1955), couples therapist. **Det. Lawrence Fyffe** (b. November 21, 1966), 113th Precinct. **Daniella** (b. 1978), a Fordham Law student. Trustees named but unseen: Hollingsworth, Edmonds, Rev. Ashworth and Judge Kittredge.

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- October 3, 2005: Marshall and Warren won the Nobel Prize for *H. pylori*; Marshall drank a culture in 1984. President Bush nominated Harriet Miers to the Supreme Court. The Yankees-Angels ALDS opened October 4. Baisley Park Houses (South Jamaica) is in the NYPD 113th Precinct.
- Medicine: open fetal resection of sacrococcygeal teratoma for high-output failure and hydrops was performed at a handful of centers (CHOP, UCSF) before 2005, and mirror (Ballantyne) syndrome is an indication. Damage-control laparotomy with a Pringle maneuver and perihepatic packing is standard; retained bullets near the IVC are left alone. Microvascular decompression (Jannetta) for trigeminal neuralgia uses Teflon felt. ISHLT 1990 grade 3A rejection was treated with pulse methylprednisolone. Meckel's diverticulum with ectopic gastric mucosa can cause painless or painful lower-GI bleeding.